

RIGGINS STRATEGIC SOLUTIONS

The Simple Blueprint

Your Essential Guide to Senior Transitions

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FREE COMPANION RESOURCES

This guide references tools, calculators, and worksheets from the full Senior Transition Blueprint system. You can access additional free tools at:

rigginsstrategicsolutions.com

Available free tools include:

- Net Proceeds Calculator - rigginsstrategicsolutions.com/net-proceeds-calculator
- Strategic Exit Engine - rigginsstrategicsolutions.com/strategic-exit-engine
- Home Prep Quiz - rigginsstrategicsolutions.com/prepquiz
- Transition Readiness Assessment - rigginsstrategicsolutions.com/transitions-ready
- Beneficiary Designation Audit - rigginsstrategicsolutions.com/beneficiary-designation-audit
- Caregiver Burnout Quiz - rigginsstrategicsolutions.com/caregiver-burnout-quiz
- Aging in Place Break-Even Tool - rigginsstrategicsolutions.com/age-in-place-break-even-tool

tool

- Medicare Gap Analyzer - rigginsstrategicsolutions.com/medicare-gap-analyzer
- \$5K Smart Prep Budget Calculator - rigginsstrategicsolutions.com/smart-prep-budget-calculator

calculator

Want the complete system? The Senior Transition Blueprint includes all 21 modules, 93 downloadable tools, video lessons, and our online membership portal for just \$47.

rigginsstrategicsolutions.com/blueprint

Welcome to Your Simple Blueprint This guide provides the essential frameworks, checklists, and decision-making tools you need to navigate a senior transition successfully. It is a condensed version of our complete Blueprint system, focusing on the most critical information to help you take action immediately.

Who This Is For This guide is designed for families who are organized, proactive, and willing to manage the transition process themselves with expert guidance. It is ideal for budget-conscious families who want a professional framework without the cost of full-service coordination.

What You Get

- Core frameworks from all 14 phases of the transition process
- 15 essential checklists and worksheets to keep you on track
- Quick-start action plans to build momentum immediately
- Decision-making guides to reduce overwhelm and confusion

Want the complete system? The Senior Transition Blueprint (\$47) includes all 21 modules, 71 downloadable tools, video lessons, and our online membership portal. The Premium Blueprint (\$297) adds a personalized transition plan, a 60-minute coaching call with Ryan, and 90 days of priority email support. Visit rigginsstrategicsolutions.com/blueprint

How to Use This Guide

1. Read Through Once: Get the big-picture overview before diving into specific modules. 2. Assess Your Stage: Honestly evaluate where you are in the process (Early Planning, Preparing to Move, or Urgent Transition).

3. Focus on Relevant Sections: Skip ahead to the modules that apply to your current situation. 4. Use the Checklists: Print them out and check off tasks as you complete them. 5. Revisit as Needed: Keep this guide as your go-to reference throughout the entire transition.

Estimated Time to Complete: 2-6 months, depending on your timeline and complexity.

Module 0: Quick Start & Orientation

The 7-Day Quick Start Plan If you are just starting and feel overwhelmed, follow this simple 7-day plan to build immediate momentum.

Day Focus Area Tasks

Day 1 Assess Your Situation Answer the 6 Foundational Questions. Identify your timeline. List who is involved in helping.

Day 2 Create Your Support Identify the primary decision-maker. List family members who Team will help. Identify which professionals you'll need.

Day 3 Set Your First Milestone Pick ONE small area to declutter this week. Schedule 2 hours to complete it. Celebrate the win.

Day 4 Safety First Walk through the home and identify fall hazards. Make a list of immediate safety fixes needed. Address the top 3 safety issues this week.

Day 5 Research Next Home Research 3 community options online. Browse homes in target Options area. Research modification contractors if aging in place.

Day 6 Financial Reality Check Estimate home value (Zillow, Redfin for ballpark). List all monthly expenses. Estimate transition costs using rough numbers.

Day 7 Create Your Timeline Mark target move date on calendar. Work backwards to identify key milestones. Schedule next week's tasks.

After 7 days, you will have clarity, a plan, and momentum.

The 6 Foundational Questions Before you dive in, answer these six questions. They will shape your entire approach.

1. WHY is this transition happening?

■ Safety concerns ■ Social isolation ■ Health decline ■ Financial reasons ■ Proactive planning ■ Family pressure ■ Other: _____

2. WHO is making the decisions?

■ Senior alone ■ Senior with family input ■ Family with senior input ■ Power of Attorney ■ Shared decision-making Primary decision-maker: _____

3. WHEN does this need to happen?

■ No rush (1-5+ years) ■ General timeframe (6-12 months) ■ Specific target date: _____ ■ Urgent (0-3 months)

4. WHERE is the senior going?

■ Independent Living ■ Assisted Living ■ Memory Care ■ Downsizing to smaller home ■ Aging in place
■ Moving in with family ■ Not sure yet

5. WHAT support do we have?

■ Family nearby (can help physically) ■ Family out of state (remote coordination) ■ No nearby family
Time available: [] Plenty [] Moderate [] Limited

6. HOW much can we spend?

Home sale proceeds: \$_____ Savings available: \$_____ Budget: [] Flexible []
Moderate [] Tight

Your answers to these questions will determine your approach. Keep them handy.

Module 1: Your New Starting Point

Understanding Your Stage Every transition falls into one of three stages. Identify yours and adjust your approach accordingly.

Stage 1: Early Planning (1-5+ years out) You are proactive and have no immediate pressure. Use this time wisely.

Focus On:

- Gradual decluttering (2 bags per week method)
- Building savings for the transition
- Researching community options
- Having early conversations with family
- Getting estate planning documents in order

Don't Worry About:

- Detailed move planning
- Vendor selection
- Urgent repairs

Stage 2: Preparing to Move (3-12 months out) The decision is made, and the timeline is set. Time to execute.

Focus On:

- Systematic decluttering (room by room)
- Community tours and selection
- Home preparation and repairs
- Vendor research and hiring
- Financial planning and budgeting
- Family communication and task distribution

Stage 3: Urgent Transition (0-3 months) A health crisis or immediate need is forcing a move. Speed is critical.

Focus On:

- Safety first (fall prevention, immediate hazards)
- Selling the home as-is (don't waste time on repairs)
- Hiring professionals (movers, cleaners, coordinators)
- Keeping only essentials (aggressive downsizing)
- Finding a community with immediate availability

Identify Your Stage: _____

The Fear Inventory Transitions bring fear. The first step is to name them so you can shrink them.

Common Fears:

■ Fear of making the wrong decision ■ Fear of losing independence ■ Fear of family conflict ■ Fear of running out of money ■ Fear of the senior's resistance ■ Fear of overwhelming workload ■ Fear of missing something important

For Each Fear, Ask:

1. Is this fear based on facts or assumptions? 2. What is the WORST that could happen? 3. What is the BEST that could happen? 4. What is the MOST LIKELY outcome? 5. What can I control? 6. What must I accept?

Most fears shrink when examined closely.

Module 2: Decluttering Phase

The 5-Pile Sorting System Every item in the home gets sorted into one of five piles.

Pile Criteria Action PILE 1: KEEP Used in last 6 months OR brings genuine joy Moving forward OR essential PILE 2: DONATE Functional, clean, not needed Good condition, someone else can use PILE 3: SELL Worth \$50+, have time to sell Valuable enough to be worth effort PILE 4: TRASH Broken, damaged, unusable No one can use this PILE 5: DECIDE Sentimental or uncertain Limit to 10% of items LATER

The 3-Second Rule: If you can't decide in 3 seconds, it goes to Pile 5. Come back to Pile 5 items in 2 weeks with fresh eyes.

The Two-Bag Daily Tidy

For gradual decluttering (Stage 1 - Early Planning):

Every Day:

- Bag 1: DONATE (find 3-5 items)
- Bag 2: TRASH (find 3-5 items)

When bags are full, remove from home immediately.

Results:

- In 30 days: 60-100 bags removed = Huge progress
- In 90 days: 180-300 bags removed = Transformed home

This method prevents overwhelm. Small daily actions compound.

Early Wins Checklist

Start with easy, visible areas for quick momentum:

■ Kitchen junk drawer ■ Medicine cabinet (check expiration dates) ■ Coat closet ■ Garage/shed (broken tools, empty containers) ■ Linen closet (old towels, sheets)

■ Bathroom cabinets (old products) ■ Entryway (shoes, coats)

Result: Visible progress in 1-2 days. Motivation to continue.

Module 3: Sorting & Categorizing

Room-by-Room Sorting Approach Work through the home systematically. One room at a time.

Recommended Order:

1. Guest room / least-used space (easiest) 2. Storage areas (attic, basement, garage) 3. Bathrooms 4. Kitchen 5. Bedrooms 6. Living spaces 7. Sentimental items (LAST - hardest)

For Each Room:

1. Empty completely (if possible) 2. Clean the space 3. Sort using the 5-Pile System 4. Return only KEEP items 5. Remove other piles immediately

Time Per Room: 2-8 hours depending on size and clutter level.

The 3-Path System for Sentimental Items Sentimental items are the hardest. Use this framework.

Path Description % of Items Action
 PATH 1: Take photo, write memory, let 80% Keep the memory, not the Photograph & item go object Release
 PATH 2: Display & Items that truly bring joy, will be 15% Limit to what fits in new space Enjoy displayed in new home
 PATH 3: Archive Truly irreplaceable items for 5% One box per person maximum future generations

Rule: If you haven't looked at it in 10+ years, use PATH 1 (photograph and release).

Paperwork Sorting: The 3-Folder Method All papers go into one of three folders.

Folder What Goes Here Examples
 FOLDER 1: ACTIVE Need within 1 year Current tax returns, active insurance policies, current medical records, active bills
 FOLDER 2: ARCHIVE Legal requirement to keep Last 7 years tax returns, deed to property, birth certificates, wills, trusts, POA documents
 FOLDER 3: SHRED Everything else Old statements, outdated insurance policies, old tax returns (7+ years), expired warranties

Important: Shred anything with personal information. Don't just throw it away.

Module 4: Rightsizing the Home

Space Planning Reality Check Step 1: Measure the new home Living room: _____ ft x _____ ft Bedroom: _____ ft x _____ ft Total square footage: _____

Step 2: Measure current furniture Sofa: _____ ft x _____ ft Bed: _____ ft x _____ ft Dining table: _____ ft x _____ ft

Step 3: Will it fit? ☐ Yes ☐ No ☐ Tight fit

Step 4: If it doesn't fit, you have 3 options:

■ Don't take it (donate/sell/gift) ■ Replace with smaller version ■ Choose different new home

Reality: Most furniture won't fit. Accept this early.

The Two-Week Wardrobe Test Most people wear 20% of their clothes 80% of the time. Week 1-2: Wear only what you actually use. Mark those items with a safety pin or move to front of closet. Week 3: Everything unmarked gets donated. Exception: Special occasion clothes (1-2 outfits max). Result: Wardrobe reduced by 60-80%. Easier to pack and move.

Furniture Rightsizing Decisions

For each piece of furniture, ask:

1. Will it fit in new space? ☐ Yes ☐ No 2. Is it in good condition? ☐ Yes ☐ No 3. Will senior actually use it? ☐ Yes ☐ No

4. Is it safe (no trip hazards)? ☐ Yes ☐ No 5. Does senior LOVE it? ☐ Yes ☐ No

4-5 YES: Keep 2-3 YES: Maybe (test in layout) 0-1 YES: Don't take it

Module 5: Safety, Repairs & Smart Upgrades

Home Safety Assessment (Do This First!)

Walk through the home and check for:

Fall Hazards:

■ Loose rugs or mats ■ Clutter on floors or stairs ■ Poor lighting in hallways ■ Uneven flooring ■ Missing handrails on stairs

Bathroom Safety:

■ Grab bars installed? ■ Non-slip mats in tub/shower? ■ Raised toilet seat needed?

Kitchen Safety:

■ Heavy items on high shelves (fall risk) ■ Oven/stove in good working order ■ Fire extinguisher present and accessible

Fix safety issues first. Everything else is secondary.

Ryan's "What NOT to Fix" List Most families waste \$50K-\$100K on repairs that don't pay back.

DON'T FIX Cost DO INSTEAD Cost Full kitchen remodel \$40K Cabinet paint \$1,500 Luxury flooring \$20K Professional cleaning \$300 Instagram/HGTV staging \$10K Declutter + neutral paint \$2K Replace functional \$4,500 Deep clean \$0 appliances Structural wall removal \$15K Leave it \$0

Total Saved: \$85K-\$90K

DO FIX (if selling home):

- Safety issues (handrails, loose steps)
- Fresh paint (neutral colors)
- Deep cleaning
- Curb appeal (landscaping, front door)
- Obvious repairs (broken windows, leaky faucets)

Budget: \$2K-\$5K is usually sufficient.

The ROI Decision Framework For each repair, ask: Will this repair return more money than it costs?

High ROI (Do These):

- Fresh paint: 150% return
- Professional cleaning: 300% return
- Curb appeal: 100% return
- Cabinet refresh: 200% return

Low ROI (Skip These):

- Full kitchen remodel: 30-50% return
- Bathroom remodel: 50% return
- Luxury upgrades: 15-30% return

When in doubt: Don't fix it. Sell as-is instead.

Module 6: Financial & Legal Preparation

Estimating Transition Costs

Cost Category Typical Range Your Estimate Moving Costs \$3,000-\$8,000 \$_____ Home Preparation \$2,000-\$5,000 \$_____ Legal/Professional Fees \$3,000-\$5,000 \$_____ Overlap Costs \$5,000-\$15,000 \$_____ Contingency (10%) - \$_____ TOTAL ESTIMATE \$15,000-\$40,000 \$_____

Source of Funds:

■ Home sale proceeds ■ Savings ■ Family contributions ■ Bridge loan ■ Reverse mortgage

The Four Must-Have Documents

1. WILL

- Specifies who gets your assets

- Names executor
- Names guardians for minor children

2. FINANCIAL POWER OF ATTORNEY

- Gives someone authority to handle finances if you're incapacitated
- Without it, family must go to court (expensive, time-consuming)

3. HEALTHCARE POWER OF ATTORNEY

- Gives someone authority to make medical decisions if you can't
- Without it, doctors may not share info with family

4. LIVING WILL / ADVANCE DIRECTIVE

- States your wishes for end-of-life care
- Takes burden off family to guess

The Forgotten Detail: Beneficiary Designations Life insurance, 401k, IRA, and bank accounts all have beneficiary designations. These **OVERRIDE** your will.

Example: Your will says everything goes to your 3 kids equally. But your 401k still lists your ex-spouse from 20 years ago. Result: Ex-spouse gets the 401k. The will doesn't matter.

Update beneficiaries every time life changes:

- Marriage
- Divorce
- Birth of child
- Death of beneficiary

When to Consult Professionals

Professional When to Use Cost
 Estate Attorney Wills, trusts, powers of attorney \$2,000-\$5,000
 Financial Planner Retirement withdrawals, tax implications \$1,500-\$3,000
 CPA Tax planning around asset sales \$500-\$2,000
 Elder Law Attorney Medicaid planning, long-term care funding \$3,000-\$7,000

Don't DIY complex estate planning. Get expert help.

Module 7: Senior Community Exploration

Types of Senior Living

Type	Description	Level of Care	Cost (Monthly)
Independent Living	Active seniors, minimal help.	Minimal	\$2,000-\$5,000
Assisted Living	Meals, housekeeping, activities. Help with daily activities. 24-hour staff.	Moderate	\$3,500-\$7,000
Memory Care	Specialized for dementia/Alzheimer's. Secure environment.	High	\$5,000-\$10,000
Nursing Home	Highest level of medical care.	Very High	\$7,000-\$12,000

What to Look For When Touring

First Impressions:

■ Clean and well-maintained? ■ Friendly staff? ■ Residents seem happy? ■ Smells fresh (not institutional)?

Food:

■ Tour the dining room ■ Ask to sample a meal ■ Menu variety?

Activities:

■ Robust activity calendar? ■ Residents engaged or isolated? ■ Outings and trips?

Staff:

■ Adequate staff-to-resident ratio? ■ Low turnover? ■ Well-trained?

Costs:

■ All-inclusive or add-ons? ■ What's included in base price? ■ Extra fees for care levels?

Red Flags

- High-pressure sales
- Won't let you tour unannounced
- Residents seem unhappy
- Bad smells
- Staff overwhelmed
- Vague about costs
- Bad online reviews

Trust your gut. If something feels off, it probably is.

Module 8: Estate Planning Essentials

Medicaid Planning Basics If you think you might need Medicaid to pay for long-term care in the future, you need to plan ahead. Medicaid has strict asset and income limits, and there is a 5-year "look-back" period.

What Medicaid Looks At:

- Transfers of assets in the last 5 years
- Gifting money to family
- Selling property below market value
- Transferring bank accounts

Before You Do Anything: Consult an elder law attorney. Don't accidentally disqualify yourself from Medicaid.

Cost of Attorney: \$2,000-\$5,000 **Cost of Mistake:** Medicaid ineligibility (hundreds of thousands) It's worth the investment.

The Digital Estate Plan Don't forget your digital assets.

Create a list of:

■ Email accounts and passwords ■ Social media accounts ■ Online banking and financial accounts ■ Subscription services ■ Cloud storage accounts ■ Digital photos and files

Store this list securely and tell your Power of Attorney where to find it.

Module 9: Home Sale Strategy

The 7 Exit Strategies Most people think there's only one way to sell a home: list it with a realtor. There are actually seven strategies, and the right one depends on your timeline, condition of the home, and financial goals.

Strategy Best For Timeline Pros Cons

1. Traditional Homes in good 30-60 days Highest price Requires prep, MLS Listing condition showings
2. As-Is Sale Urgent timeline, 30-45 days No repairs needed Lower price poor condition
3. Cash Investor Urgent, need 7-14 days Fast, no repairs Lowest price (60-70% of value)
4. Owner Buyer can't get Flexible Higher price, monthly Delayed full payout Financing traditional loan income
5. Lease-Option Slow market, Flexible Monthly income, Tenant risk need income future sale
6. 1031 Tax-deferred sale 45-180 days Defer capital gains tax Must reinvest in Exchange property
7. Keep as Rental Generate passive Ongoing Monthly cash flow Landlord income responsibilities

Most families default to Strategy #1 without considering the others.

Pricing Strategy

The 3-Tier Pricing Model:

1. Aggressive Price (5-10% below market): Generates multiple offers, sells fast.
2. Market Price: Attracts serious buyers, sells in 30-60 days.
3. Premium Price (5-10% above market): Tests the market, may sit longer.

Ryan's Recommendation: Price at market value or slightly below. Overpricing costs you time and money.

Negotiation Basics

The 3 Levers in Every Negotiation:

6. Price: What the buyer pays 7. Terms: When they close, contingencies, repairs 8. Timing: Move-out date, flexibility

You can't win on all three. Decide which matters most to you and be willing to compromise on the others.

Module 10: Move Management & Coordination

The T-Minus Timeline

Timeframe Tasks
T-Minus 30 Days Book movers. Order packing supplies. Begin packing non-essentials. Notify utility companies. Submit change of address.
T-Minus 14 Days Confirm all vendors. Pack 70-80% of belongings. Label boxes clearly. Prepare "essentials box" for first 24 hours.
T-Minus 7 Days Finalize packing (90-95%). Reconfirm movers. Empty storage areas. Do final walkthrough of new home.
T-Minus 1 Day Pack everything except bare essentials. Charge all devices. Print move-day plan. Get good sleep.
T-Day (Move Day) Supervise movers. Check off inventory. Do final walkthrough of old home. Direct placement at new home.

The "Move Day Bag" (Keep With You) ■ Important documents (IDs, insurance, medical records) ■ Medications ■ Valuables ■ Phone chargers ■ Snacks and water ■ Change of clothes ■ Toiletries ■ Cash

Do NOT let this bag go on the moving truck.

Module 11: Final Move-Out & Home Transition

The Final Walkthrough Checklist Before you hand over the keys, do a final walkthrough. ■ All personal belongings removed ■ All trash and debris removed ■ All appliances clean (if leaving them) ■ All light fixtures working ■ All windows and doors locked ■ Thermostat set appropriately ■ Garage door opener left (if applicable) ■ Keys and remotes ready to hand over

Utility Shut-Off Checklist ■ Electric (schedule shut-off for day after closing) ■ Gas ■ Water ■ Internet/Cable ■ Trash service ■ Security system

Don't shut off utilities until AFTER closing.

Module 12: Settling Into Your New Home

The First 30 Days
Week 1: Essentials ■ Unpack essentials box ■ Set up bed and bathroom ■ Stock kitchen basics ■ Locate emergency exits and fire extinguisher
Week 2: Functionality ■ Unpack kitchen ■ Unpack bedroom ■ Set up living spaces ■ Hang pictures and personal items
Week 3: Routine ■ Establish daily routine ■ Explore the community ■ Meet neighbors ■ Find local services (pharmacy, grocery, etc.)
Week 4: Connection ■ Attend community activities ■ Join a club or group ■ Invite family to visit ■ Celebrate the transition

Building Community The first 90 days are critical for building social connections.

Action Steps:

- Introduce yourself to neighbors ■ Attend at least 3 community events ■ Join one ongoing activity or club ■ Eat meals in the dining room (if applicable) ■ Volunteer for a committee

Isolation is the enemy. Connection is the goal.

Module 13: Family Communication & Reducing Stress

The Family Meeting Framework

Before the Meeting:

- Set a clear agenda ■ Share it in advance ■ Assign a note-taker ■ Set a time limit

During the Meeting:

- Start with positives ■ Address concerns one at a time ■ Make decisions, don't just discuss ■ Assign action items with deadlines

After the Meeting:

- Send summary of decisions and action items ■ Schedule next meeting ■ Follow up on commitments

Conflict Resolution Strategies

When Family Members Disagree:

9. Separate the person from the problem. Attack the issue, not each other. 10. Listen to understand, not to respond. Everyone needs to feel heard. 11. Focus on shared goals. You all want what's best for the senior. 12. Compromise where possible. No one gets everything they want. 13. Make a decision and move forward. Don't relitigate the same discussions.

Self-Care for Caregivers You can't pour from an empty cup.

- Schedule breaks ■ Ask for help ■ Set boundaries ■ Maintain your own health appointments ■ Connect with other caregivers ■ Consider respite care if needed

Taking care of yourself is not selfish. It's necessary.

Essential Tools & Checklists Quick Reference Checklists

Decluttering Checklist:

- Start with easy wins (junk drawer, medicine cabinet) ■ Use the 5-Pile System (Keep, Donate, Sell, Trash, Decide Later) ■ Work room by room ■ Use the 3-Second Rule for decisions

Home Prep Checklist:

- Safety assessment complete ■ Fresh paint (neutral colors) ■ Deep cleaning ■ Curb appeal improvements ■ Obvious repairs completed

Moving Day Checklist:

■ Move Day Bag packed ■ Movers confirmed ■ Utilities scheduled ■ Final walkthrough complete ■ Keys and remotes ready

Your Next Steps You now have the framework, checklists, and decision-making tools to navigate this transition successfully. The key is to take action, one step at a time.

Ready for the Complete System?

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THE PREMIUM BLUEPRINT - \$297 Everything in the \$47 Blueprint PLUS a personalized transition plan built around your specific situation, a 60-minute coaching call with Ryan, and 90 days of priority email support. Get it at rigginsstrategicsolutions.com/blueprint

SENIORSAFE APP - 14 DAYS FREE TRIAL Coordinate your family with daily check-ins, an AI assistant, a secure document vault, medication tracking, and family messaging. Premium+ adds Maggie, the AI specialist for adult children running point on a parent's transition. After trial: \$14.99/mo Premium or \$39.99/mo Premium+. Start at seniorsafeapp.com

Free Tools & Resources Visit rigginsstrategicsolutions.com for additional free calculators, quizzes, and worksheets.

Have Questions? Text Ryan directly at (336) 553-8933. He reads and responds to every message.

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